CHASE GOBBLE

Creative director, founding designer, & design engineer

Block-shaped creative leader with 19+ years threading together brand design, product design, visual design, business strategy, and design engineering into unified systems for technology companies from founding stage through IPO. I'm a designer with deep, demonstrated skill across five distinct disciplines (see below), each reinforcing the others. Currently serving as an embedded creative director helping startups bootstrap AI processes and build AI product offerings, and actively seeking an in-house founding designer or creative leadership role where I can commit to one company's mission, compound results over time, and build something with big ambitions. All workflows are AI-native, operating daily with Claude Code, Cursor, and Figma.

EXPERTISE & CAPABILITIES

Brand Design
Creative direction, identity systems, visual brand frameworks, art direction, typography, investor narrative and pitch design
Product Design
Experience architecture, information architecture, design systems, component libraries, web strategy, prototyping
Business Strategy
Market positioning, go-to-market communications, OKR-aligned operations, brief-led governance, executive communications

Design Engineering
Front-end development (React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Git), AI-native workflows (Claude Code, Cursor, Figma Make, Lovable), design-to-code production
Leadership
Cross-functional team building and mentorship, creative operations at scale, video production and motion design, studio critique culture

SELECTED PROJECTS

Finfuego
AI product, brand system, and investor narrative
nSight
Integrated event creative and keynote story

Stanford University, Shorenstein APARC
Campaign system and design-led launch engine
Young Scientist Academy
Pro bono nonprofit rebrand and fundraising enablement
Coraa AI
AI product and brand design system, market launch, and investor narrative

RECENT IMPACT STATS

Supported +$100M in client funding rounds through brand systems and investor narrative design in a single calendar year
Improved creative project delivery timelines by 4X through AI-assisted workflows and process design
Consulted with multiple AI startups on bootstrapping AI into their design and product operations

Increased site conversion by 3X (enterprise) and up to 6X (select startups) through narrative-led web architecture
Shipped 20+ integrated campaigns across global regions and cross-product portfolios

Clerestory Group//Founding Partner & Creative Director//2020-present
Co-founded a design cooperative with two longtime collaborators, built on a flat-fee sprint model that translates business goals into focused, measurable creative projects. I partner directly with seed-to-growth-stage AI and technology companies as an embedded creative director building brand systems, product experiences, and investor narratives from the ground up while helping founders integrate AI capabilities into their design operations and product offerings.

- Serve as founding designer and distributed creative director for AI product startups, owning brand identity, product design, web architecture, and go-to-market from day one
- Consult with founders on integrating AI into their product development and design workflows, building operational AI fluency from the inside out
- Curated a new workflow system for handling the ever-changing front of product building; meant as a replacement for Agile, this framework puts ultimate importance on the design and engineering cohesiveness and uses robust design systems to create highly capable AI-assisted product building that moves fast and removes the handoff bottleneck
- Build dynamic identity systems and visual brand frameworks that scale from pitch deck through product-market fit
- Design investor narratives, pitch materials, and market positioning that have supported over $100M in combined client funding rounds
- Architect web experiences using narrative-led information architecture, increasing site conversion by up to 6X for select startup clients
- Operate with AI-native workflows like Claude Code for design system scaffolding and code generation, Cursor for rapid front-end prototyping, Figma for iterative visual design
- Synthesize business strategy, user experience, and market positioning into unified design systems that serve customers, investors, and internal teams

nCino//Global Creative Director, Head of Creative//2018-2025
Built, led, and scaled a global creative organization of 15 team members across three continents, spanning design, video and motion, web, SEO, and copy. Established a brief-led operating system tied to marketing OKRs that brought sprint discipline, critique cadence, and governance to all creative production.

- Directed all visual design, brand production, and creative strategy for a publicly traded fintech company through IPO and sustained growth
- Built and maintained a design system and brand templating library that improved template adoption by 22% and reduced production bottlenecks across distributed teams
- Led, produced, and directed a remote-first IPO roadshow video package during a volatile market period, unifying the company narrative for investor, customer, and internal audiences
- Partnered with Product and Engineering on cross-functional product strategy, contributing design direction to major platform launches
- Introduced AI-assisted production workflows that improved creative project delivery timelines by 4X while maintaining craft standards
- Led a comprehensive global web overhaul, re-architecting from technical catalog to narrative-driven brand experience, resulting in 3X site conversion increase
- Managed 30% year-over-year growth in creative project volume while maintaining a flat headcount through process optimization and early AI tooling

W2O Group//Associate Creative Director//2015-2018
Elevated from contract designer to in-house role and promoted to Associate Creative Director. Partnered with biotech startups and venture capital firms to build corporate identities, drug sub-brands, and investor-facing communications.

- Led cross-functional teams of designers, scientists, founders, and communications specialists to deliver brand identities, pitch decks, annual reports, and digital assets for healthcare and life sciences companies
- Served clients including Agios, Moma Therapeutics, Thrive, Third Rock Ventures, Bluebird Bio, and Maze Therapeutics
- Translated complex scientific and technical subject matter into clear, high-impact brand narratives for investor engagement, product launches, and IPO milestones
- Developed strategic visual positioning that strengthened market narratives for early-stage biotech ventures through funding rounds and regulatory milestones

Amazon, AWS//Designer//2013-2015
Designed management console experiences for Amazon Web Services, contributing to service-level UI redesigns and usability improvements during the platform's push toward mobile-aware enterprise interfaces.

- Refined early console interface patterns for clarity, density, and flow across cloud management tools used by millions of developers and engineering teams
- Contributed to the Elastic Beanstalk console redesign and related service interface improvements
- Transitioned from UI design into visual design production, working across a broad range of brand and marketing projects for the AWS ecosystem

EDUCATION

The New School, Parsons School of Design
MFA in Photography

The New School, Parsons School of Design
BBA in Strategic Design & Management

The New School, Lang College of Liberal Arts
BA in Philosophy

RECENT REFERENCES

Chase is one of the rare creative leaders who brings both visionary thinking and operational rigor to the table. He doesn't just manage teams, he inspires them. Under his leadership, **our global brand and creative function matured dramatically, becoming faster, more strategic, and more aligned to business outcomes**. Chase leads with empathy, agility, and precision, and his impact was felt far beyond the creative org. He elevated the entire marketing function.

Dr. Jonathan Rowe (former manager)
Chief Marketing Officer, nCino

Chase was my CD for 2 years and has been an invaluable mentor. He knew when to give direction and when to let me run with my ideas, creating a supportive environment where I felt motivated to deliver my best work. **Chase always considered the big picture and strategic goals, and I learned so much from him on how design supports marketing initiatives**. He is a rare combination of great designer, visionary and people leader, and I'm so grateful I got to work with him.

Julia Dugger (former direct report)
Senior Designer, nCino

I worked under Chase as an AD. He leads with clarity and care, pairs Bauhaus/minimalist craft with exacting attention to detail, and runs processes that protect creativity and deliver on time. **Chase brings cross-team alignment, elevates designers by playing to their strengths while pushing growth, and consistently ships polished work**.

David Hitchcock (former direct report)
Art Director, nCino

I was lucky to work alongside Chase for seven years at nCino. **His creativity, innovative thinking, and talent for rallying people around a shared vision consistently elevated our work**. His thoughtful leadership and collaborative spirit made every project more successful, more creative, and more fun.

Chrissy Hennessey (former colleague)
Director of Content, nCino

More references from leadership, direct reports, and colleagues available upon request.

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